

Day 1: Introduction to Microsoft Excel

1. What Is Microsoft Excel?

Microsoft Excel is a spreadsheet application used to store, organize, calculate, analyze, and visualize data.

We can use Excel for:

- Student marksheets
- Employee salary calculations
- Sales reports
- Expense tracking
- Attendance records
- Inventory management
- Budget planning
- Dashboards and business reports

Excel helps us convert raw data into useful information.

2. Important Excel Terms

Workbook

A **workbook** is an Excel file.

For example:

Student_Marks.xlsx

A workbook can contain one or more worksheets.

Worksheet

A **worksheet** is an individual sheet inside a workbook.

For example, one workbook may contain:

- Sheet1 – Student Details
- Sheet2 – Marks

Row

Rows run horizontally and are identified by numbers.

Examples: Row 1, Row 2, Row 3.

Column

Columns run vertically and are identified by letters.

Examples: Column A, Column B, Column C.

Cell

A cell is the intersection of a row and a column.

For example:

- A1 means Column A and Row 1.
- B5 means Column B and Row 5.

A cell is where we enter data.

Range

A range is a group of cells.

Examples:

- A1:A10 – cells from A1 to A10
- A1:C10 – cells from A1 to C10

3. Excel Interface

When we open Excel, we can see the following main areas.

Title Bar

The Title Bar displays the name of the current Excel file.

Quick Access Toolbar

This toolbar contains commonly used options such as:

- Save
- Undo
- Redo

Ribbon

The Ribbon is the top area that contains Excel commands and tools.

Common Ribbon tabs are:

- File
- Home
- Insert
- Page Layout
- Formulas
- Data
- Review
- View

Formula Bar

The Formula Bar displays the content of the currently selected cell.

It is also used to enter or edit data and formulas.

Name Box

The Name Box shows the address of the selected cell.

For example, if we select cell C5, the Name Box displays C5.

Worksheet Area

This is the main area where we enter and work with data.

Sheet Tabs

Sheet tabs are located at the bottom of the workbook.

They help us move between worksheets and create new sheets.

Status Bar

The Status Bar is located at the bottom of Excel. It can show useful information such as Sum, Average, and Count when multiple cells are selected.

4. Types of Data in Excel

We can enter different types of data in Excel.

Type of Data Example

Text	Swetha, Chennai, Product A
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Type of Data Example

Number 100, 2500, 95

Date 31-08-2026

Time 10:30 AM

Formula =A1+B1

5. Basic Operations in Excel

Entering Data

1. Select a cell.
2. Type the data.
3. Press Enter.

Editing Data

1. Double-click the cell, or select the cell and press F2.
2. Make changes.
3. Press Enter.

Deleting Data

1. Select the cell or range.
2. Press the Delete key.

Copy and Paste

- Copy: Ctrl + C
- Paste: Ctrl + V
- Cut: Ctrl + X

Undo and Redo

- Undo: Ctrl + Z
- Redo: Ctrl + Y

Save the Workbook

- Save: Ctrl + S
- Save As: F12

6. Basic Navigation Shortcuts

Shortcut	Purpose
Arrow keys	Move one cell at a time
Enter	Move to the cell below
Tab	Move to the next cell on the right
Ctrl + Arrow Key	Move to the last filled cell in a direction
Ctrl + Home	Move to cell A1
Ctrl + End	Move to the last used cell
Ctrl + S	Save workbook
Ctrl + C	Copy
Ctrl + V	Paste
Ctrl + Z	Undo

7. Activity

Create a new workbook and enter the following data.

Student ID	Student Name	Course	City
S001	Anu	Excel	Chennai
S002	Ravi	Power BI	Bangalore
S003	Meena	Excel	Hyderabad
S004	Karthik	Power BI	Chennai
S005	Priya	Excel	Coimbatore

During the demonstration, practice:

- Creating a new workbook
- Renaming Sheet1 as Student Data
- Entering data
- Selecting cells and ranges

- Editing a cell
- Copying and pasting data
- Adding a new worksheet
- Saving the file as Day_1_Excel_Basics.xlsx

8. Day 1 Assignment

Create an Excel workbook named:

Student_Information.xlsx

Create a worksheet called **Student Details** and enter details for 10 students with the following columns:

- Student ID
- Student Name
- Age
- Gender
- City
- Course
- Phone Number

Also practice:

- Renaming the worksheet
- Adding a new worksheet called Practice
- Saving the workbook correctly
- Using copy, paste, undo, and redo

10. Key Takeaways

Today, we learned:

- What Microsoft Excel is
- Workbook and worksheet
- Rows, columns, cells, and ranges

- Excel interface and Ribbon
- Types of data
- Basic data entry and editing
- Navigation and basic shortcuts